



slides tinyurl.com/icap2026-commitment

Toward an AI-assisted Comprehensive Meta-analysis of the Organizational Commitment Literature

John P. Meyer¹, David J. Stanley², Jose A. Espinoza³, Amir Mehr⁴

¹ Department of Psychology, Western University, meyer@uwo.ca

² Department of Psychology, University of Guelph, dstanley@uoguelph.ca

³ Department of Psychology, Western University, jespinoz@uwo.ca

⁴ The Synthesis Company of California, amir@thesynthesis.company

With special thanks to Behrad Khorramnazari (The Synthesis Company of California) for his work on this project.



the
**SYNTHESIS
COMPANY**
of CALIFORNIA

Coauthors

The team behind this AI-assisted meta-analysis



David J. Stanley

University of Guelph



Jose A. Espinoza

Western University



Amir Mehr

The Synthesis Company

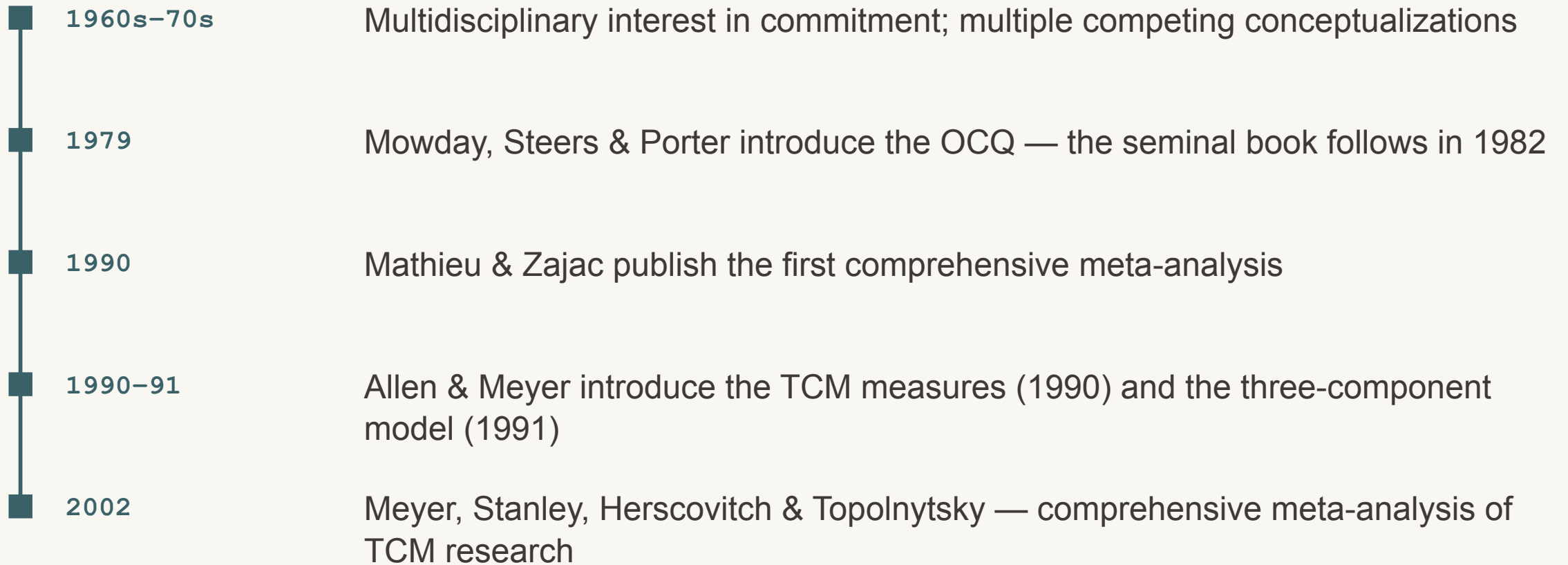
Agenda

Where we've been, where we are, and where this is going

- Brief History of Commitment Theory & Research
- Challenges to conducting comprehensive reviews
- Toward an AI-Assisted Meta-Analysis
 - Where we are
 - Where we are going
 - What is possible

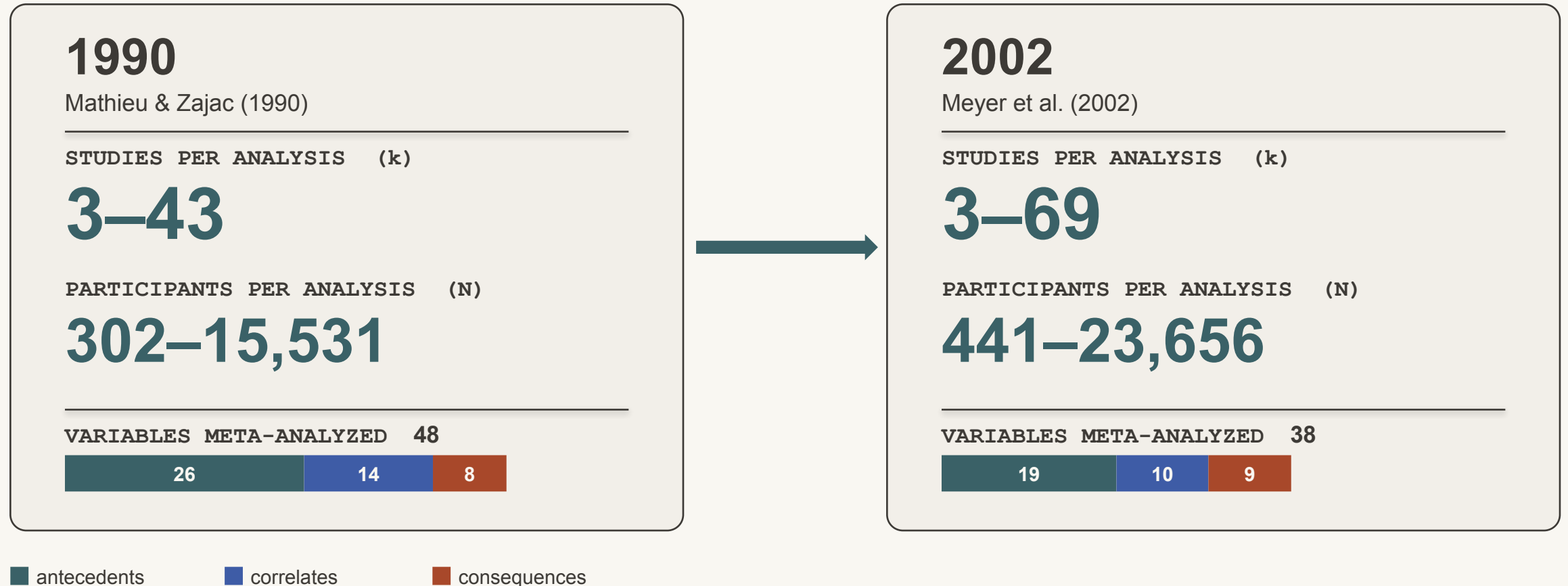
Organizational commitment: the early years

A brief history — some milestones



Two comprehensive meta-analyses

Studies (k) and participants (N) per analysis — Mathieu & Zajac (1990) and Meyer et al. (2002)

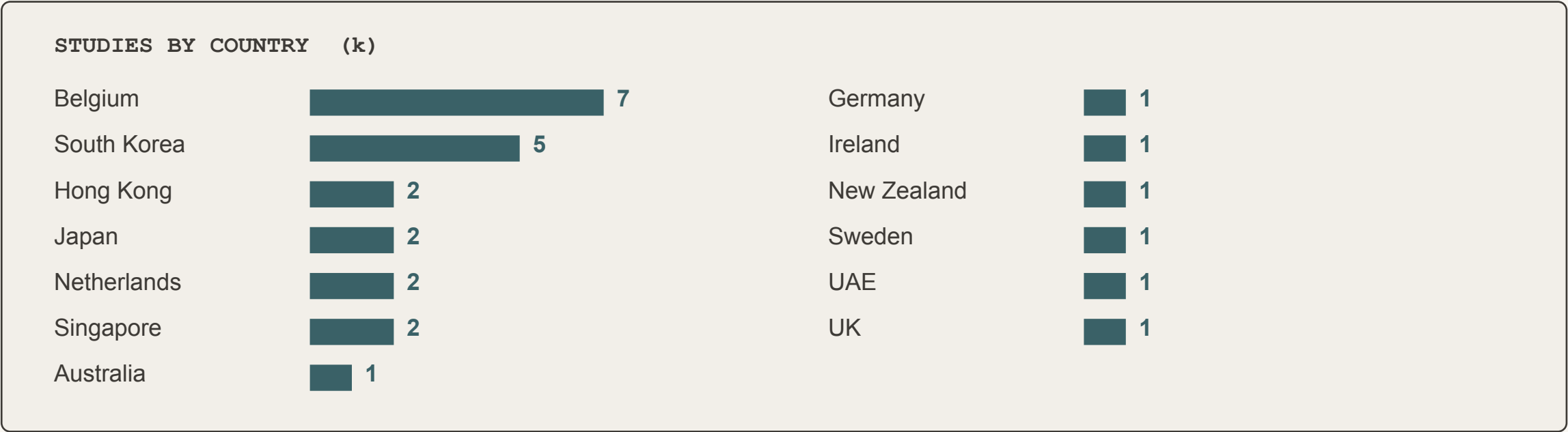


A modest cross-national base

Meyer et al. (2002) — studies reporting country of origin

■ GEOGRAPHIC REACH OF THE EVIDENCE

13 countries · 27 studies



Studies reporting country of origin (n = 27); tabulation from the ICAP 2014 presentation.

Commitment across cultures

Meyer et al. (2012) — studies (k) and participants (N) per commitment component

■ NORMATIVE DATA ASSEMBLED FROM

54 countries · **9** geographic regions

AC

Affective commitment

STUDIES (k)

966

PARTICIPANTS (N)

433,129

CC

Continuance commitment

STUDIES (k)

428

PARTICIPANTS (N)

199,831

NC

Normative commitment

STUDIES (k)

336

PARTICIPANTS (N)

133,277

Challenges to conducting comprehensive reviews

Why a truly comprehensive commitment review has become impractical by hand.

1

Studies keep growing

Commitment research piles up faster every decade.

2

Reviews turn narrow

Meta-analyses cover fewer variables to stay feasible.

3

Even narrow is too much

Now even targeted reviews outstrip human effort.

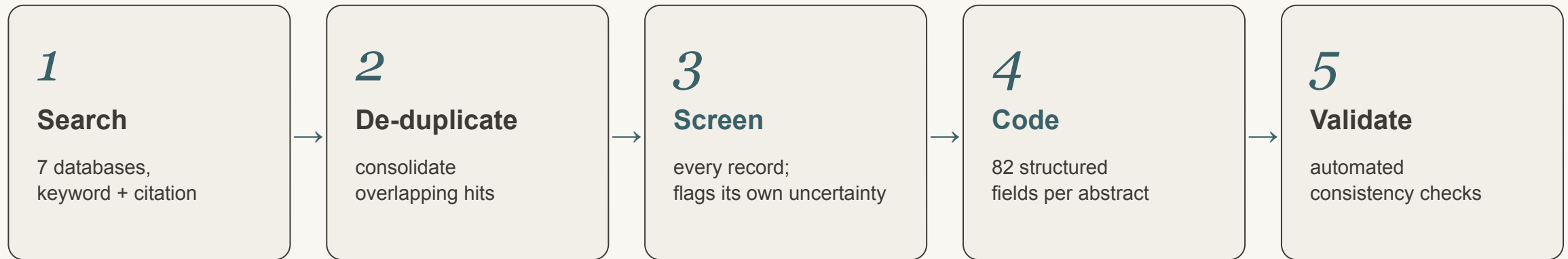
4

AI shares the labour

AI screens and codes at scale, clearing the bottleneck.

An AI-assisted pipeline — with humans in the loop

Screening and coding were performed by Eva, a family of AI agents; the team set the rules and decided every uncertain case.



HUMANS STAY IN THE LOOP

- Set & refine the inclusion rules
- Decide every case the AI flags as uncertain
- Pilot-review the coding before each full run

The AI does the volume; the team sets the rules and owns the judgment calls.

Literature search method

Two complementary search strategies in every database (except ERIC)

- **Keyword & subject-term search** — truncated organizational terms (org*, work*, employ*, job*, firm*, institution*, affect*, norm*, continu*) within three words of commit*, plus each database's subject headings; syntax adapted to each platform.
- **Cited-reference search** — every record citing any of 14 foundational commitment works (e.g., Porter et al., 1974; Mowday et al., 1979; Allen & Meyer, 1990; Meyer & Allen, 1991; Meyer et al., 2002; Klein et al., 2014).
- **Scholarly sources only** — academic journals, books, dissertations & theses, conference papers, reports, and working papers.

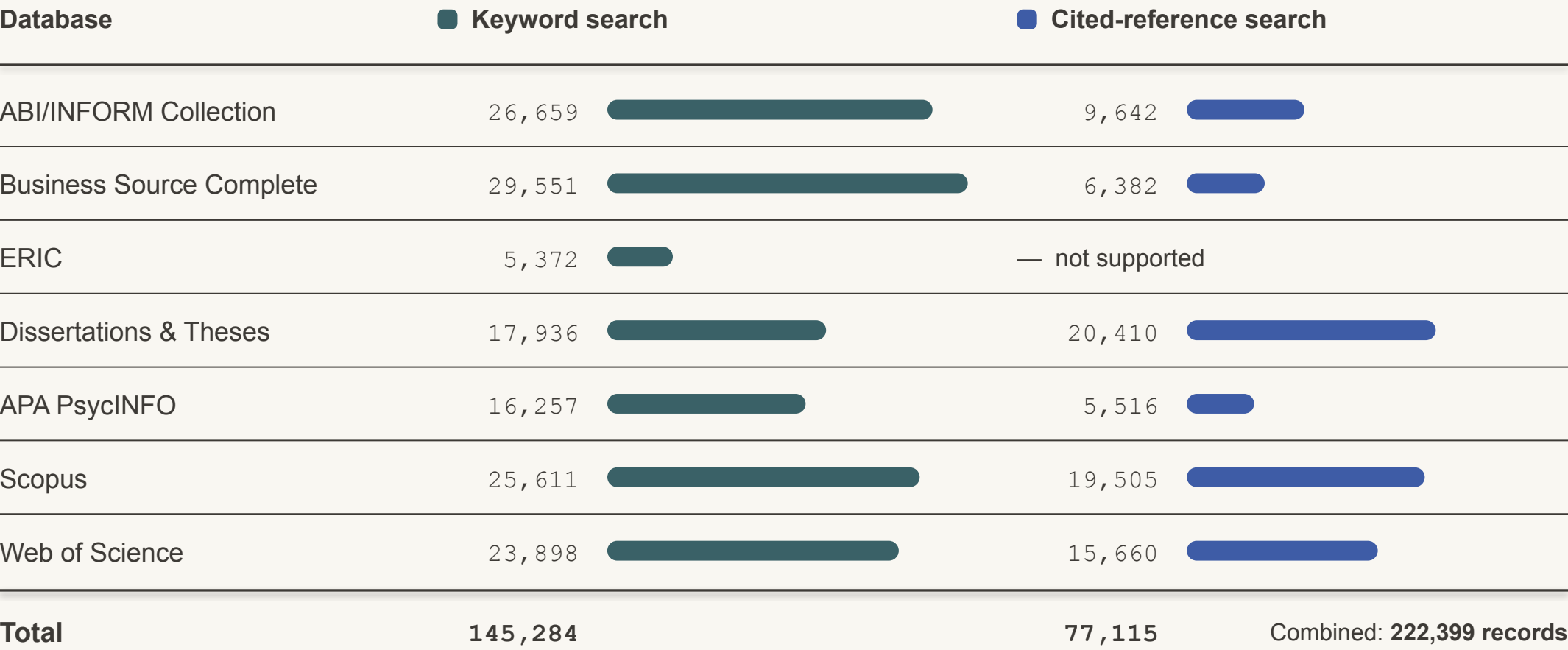
Seven databases

Searched December 20, 2025 – January 7, 2026

ABI/INFORM Collection	ProQuest
Business Source Complete	EBSCO
ERIC	Ovid · keyword only
Dissertations & Theses	ProQuest
APA PsycINFO	Ovid
Scopus	Elsevier
Web of Science	Clarivate

Records identified, by database and search strategy

Records retrieved per database, before consolidation and de-duplication · bars share one scale



ERIC (Ovid) does not support cited-reference searching.



From 222,399 records to 22,484 coded abstracts

De-duplication only removes overlap — AI relevance screening did the real narrowing

222,399 records retrieved
7 databases · keyword + citation



▼ de-duplication — *removes duplicate hits only*

113,643 unique records
after de-duplication



▼ AI relevance screening — on each record's title & abstract

22,484 coded abstracts
22,605 relevant; 121 had no abstract to code



Only ~20% of unique records passed relevance screening (22,605 of 113,643) — the rest were off-topic, not duplicates.

How accurate is AI screening? — from prior research

Before any coding, every record has to be judged relevant or not — the first filter, deciding which studies even enter the review. In earlier published validation, the AI was compared against the expert human teams who screened by hand.

■ Screening — deciding which studies belong

97.2%

of relevant studies — vs 91.6% for humans

5 meta-analyses · 30,150 abstracts screened

■ What the AI is being compared to

The human baseline was thorough — every record judged by hand:

2×

two reviewers + a 3rd

→

1 pass

the AI

≈ 98–99% less time — days or months of work, done in minutes to an hour.

[Mehr, A., Howard, J. L., Nouroozi, C., Khorramnazari, B., Banks, G. C., Tay, L., Cuijpers, P., Miguel, C., Harrer, M., Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Wang, X., Luo, G., Huo, B., Liu, J., & Rousseau, D. M. \(2026\). *Improving Evidence Synthesis with Artificial Intelligence* \[Preprint\].](#)

WHAT THE CODED ABSTRACTS REVEAL

Abstract Analysis

How the literature has grown — and what it studies.



How quickly has the literature on organizational commitment grown? Here's the annual count of articles in our collection.

Articles Published Per Year

Annual count of unique abstracts, 1970–2025 (n = 21,753 of 22,484)



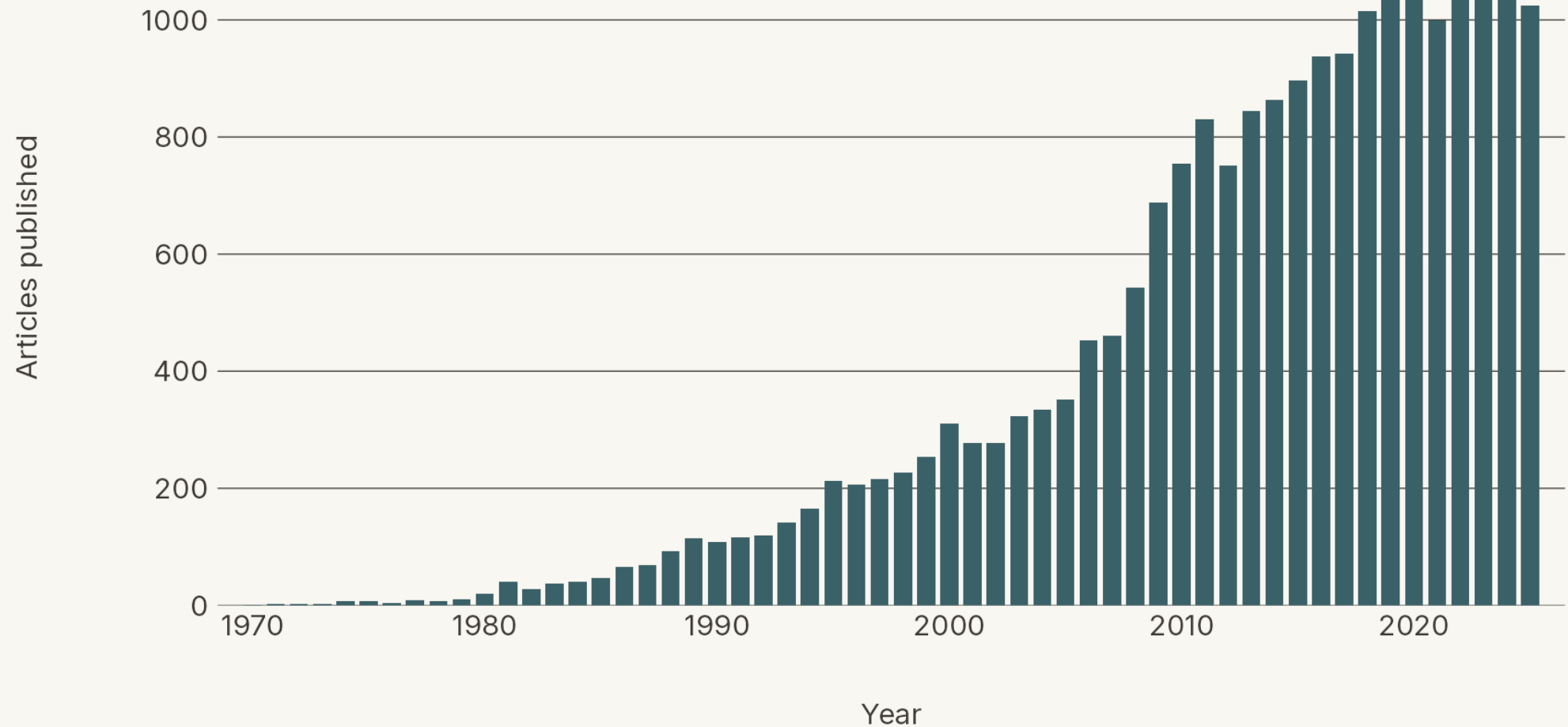
Articles Published Per Year

Annual count of unique abstracts, 1970–2025 (n = 21,753 of 22,484)



Articles Published Per Year

Annual count of unique abstracts, 1970–2025 (n = 21,753 of 22,484)

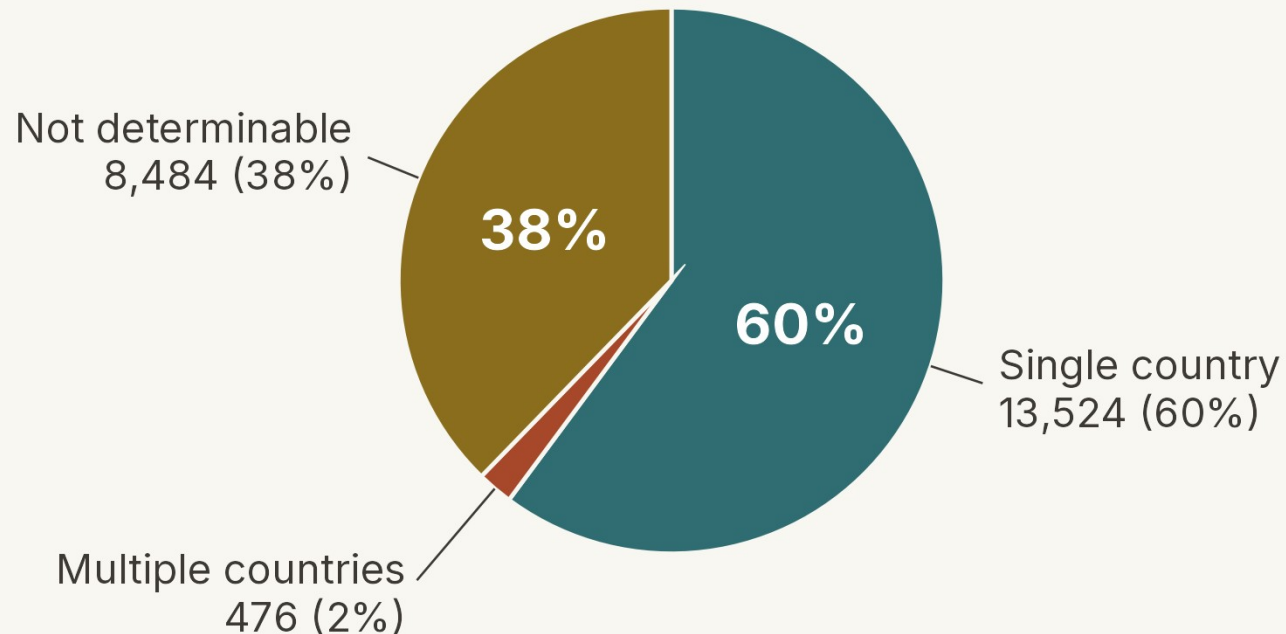




And mapped onto the globe — the geographic spread of the literature over five decades.

How many of the articles can we place geographically?

Country-coding status across all 22,484 unique abstracts



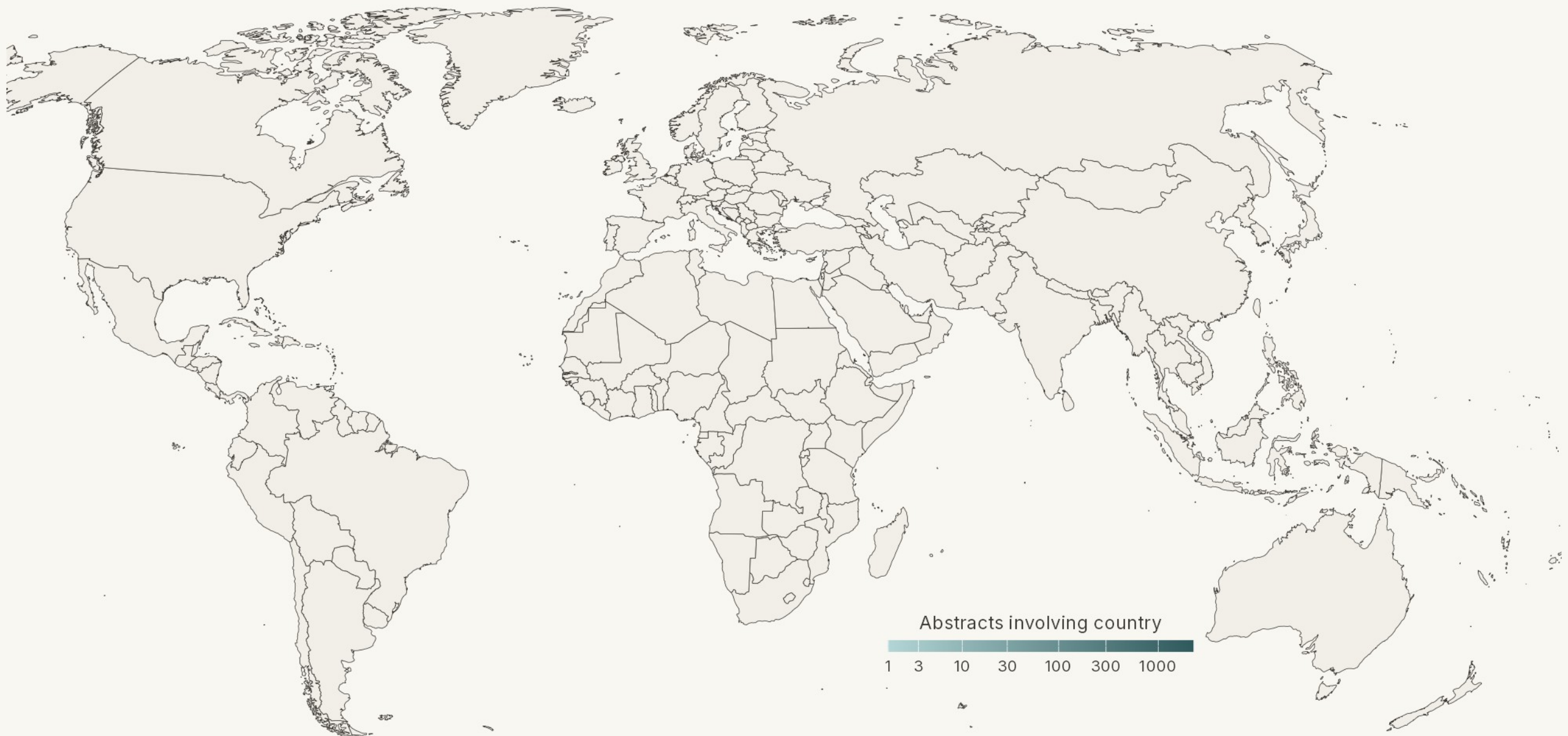
How country of origin was determined

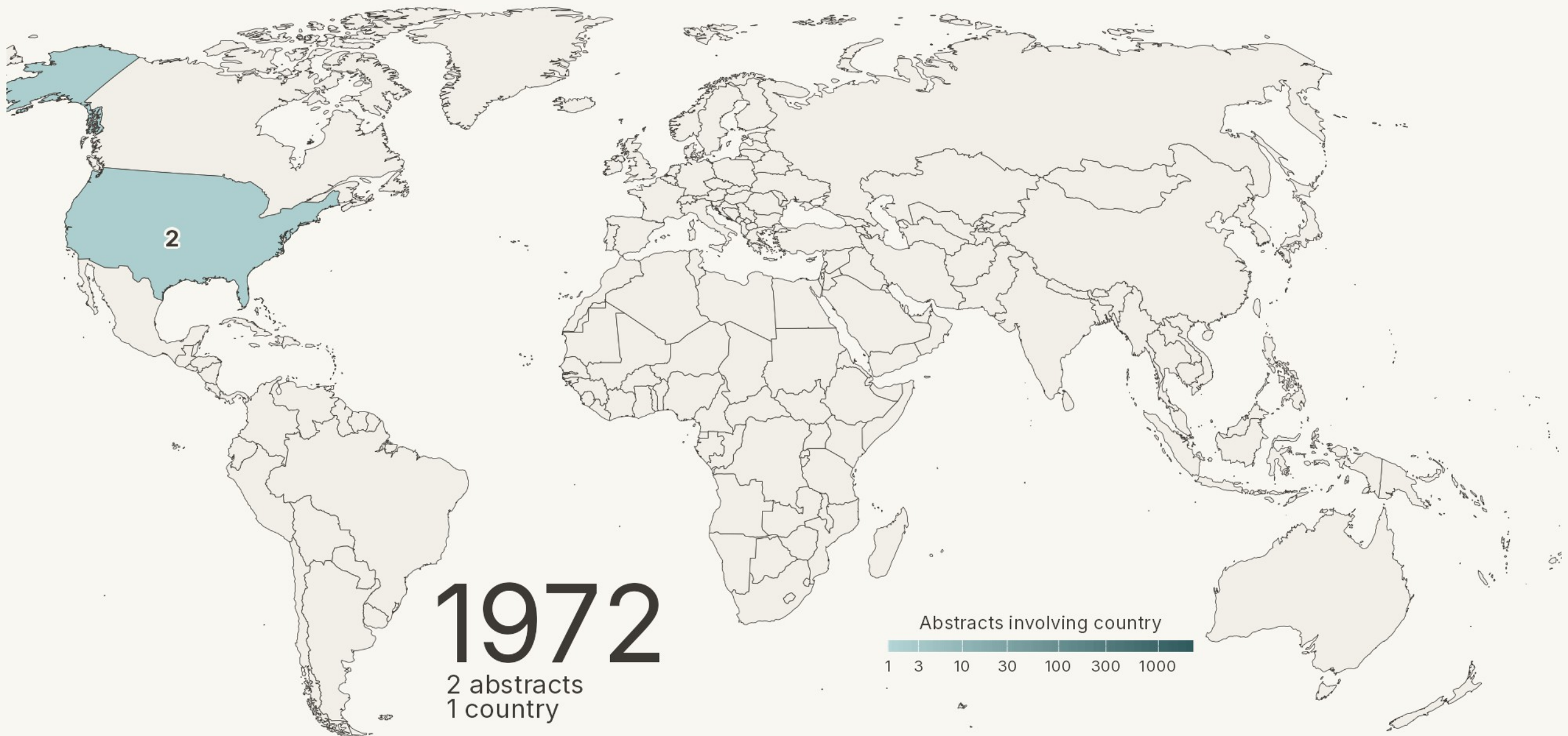
Country coding criteria (each YES / NO):

- Is a country named directly in the abstract?
- Does a stated city or region map to a country?
- Does a named company or organization map to a country?
- Do all authors' affiliations point to the same country?

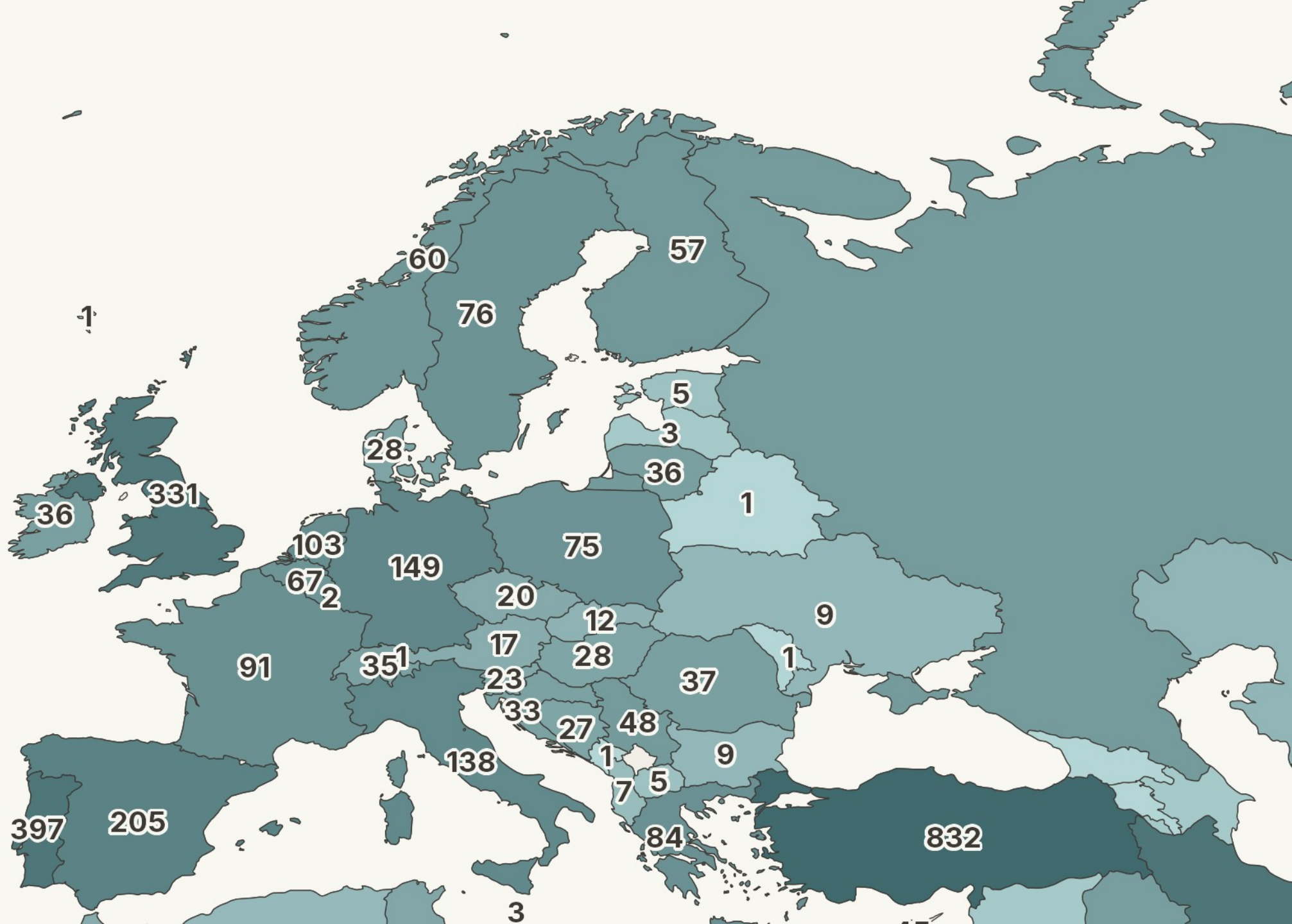
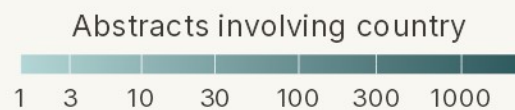
Recovering undetermined cases:

- For undetermined cases, author affiliations were retrieved from OpenAlex via DOI lookup and passed to the model, resolving 14 previously undetermined items.



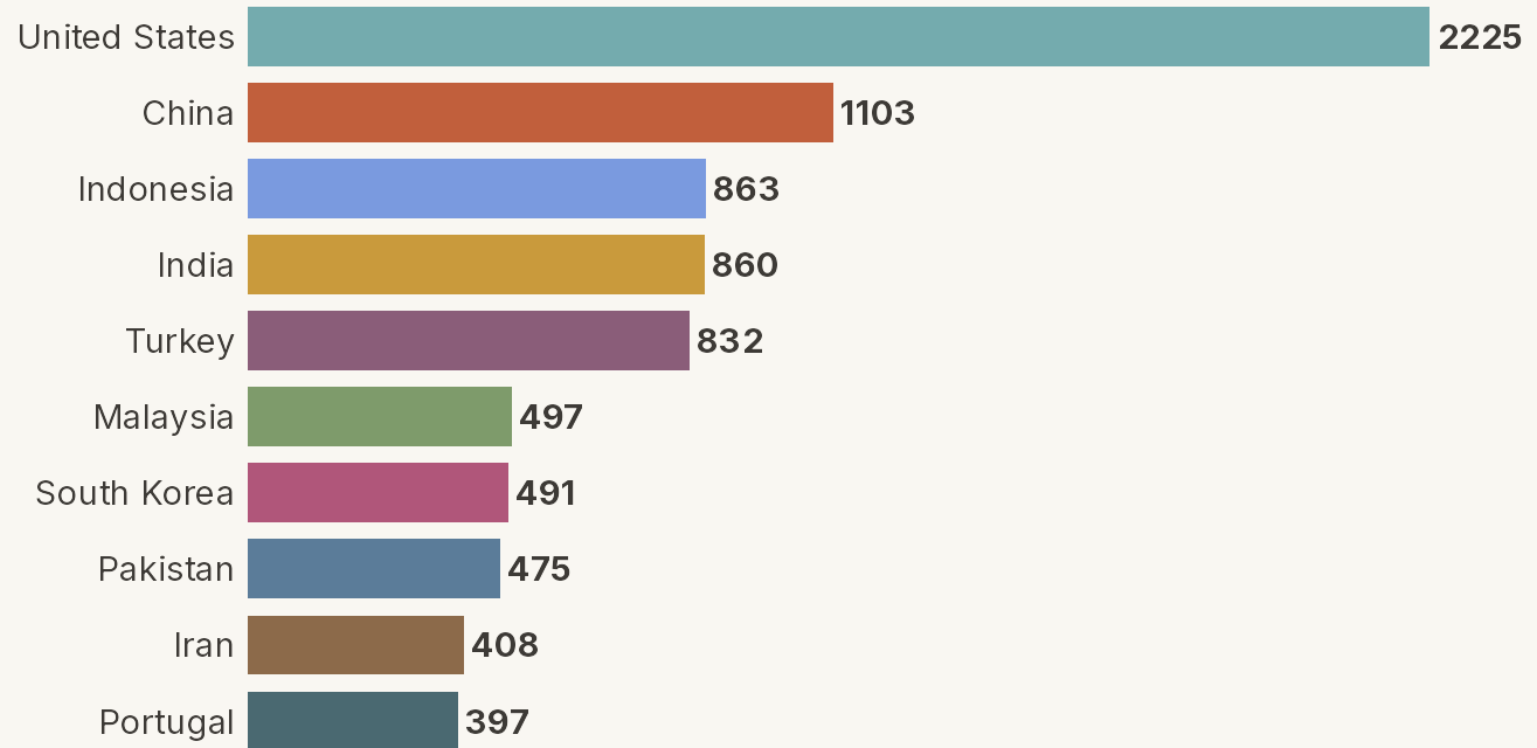


2025



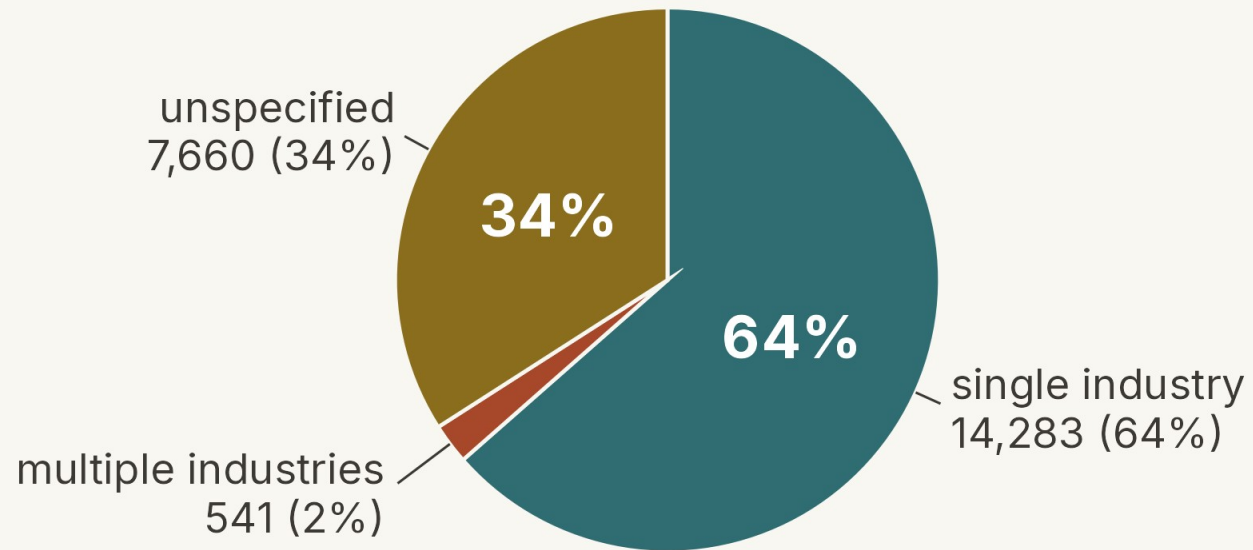
Top 10 Countries by Cumulative Samples

2025



Industry — coverage in three tiers

Full coded sample, N = 22,484



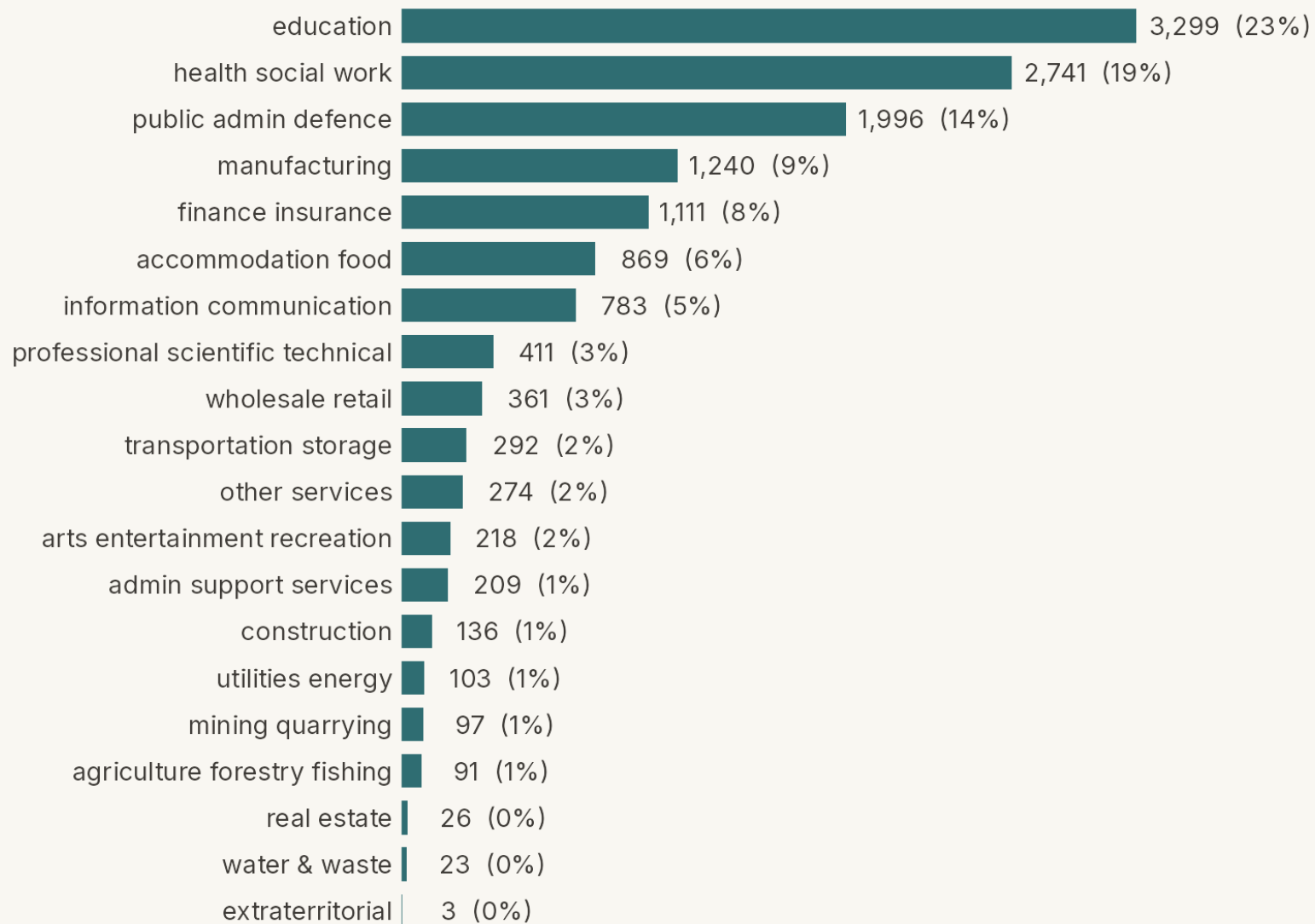
Industry taxonomy — ISIC Rev. 4

The UN's standard industry taxonomy — 21 letter-coded sections, A (agriculture, forestry & fishing) through U (extraterritorial organizations).

[Taxonomy Details Website](#)

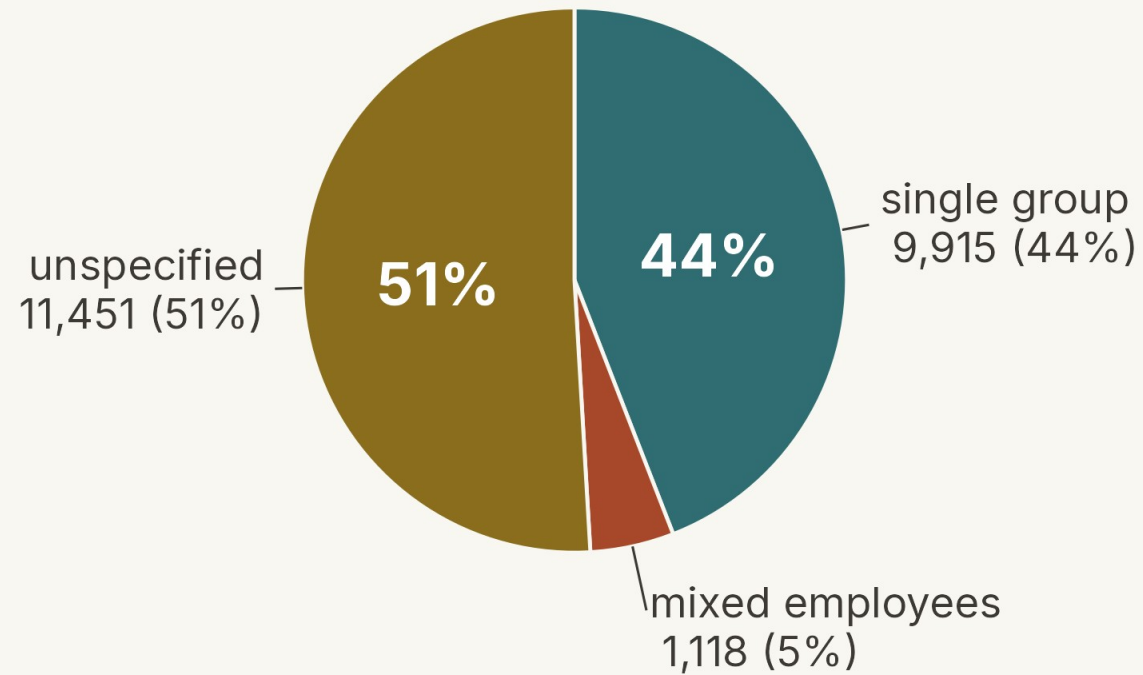
Industry — distribution among placed studies

Single-industry studies, N = 14,283



Occupation — coverage in three tiers

Full coded sample, N = 22,484



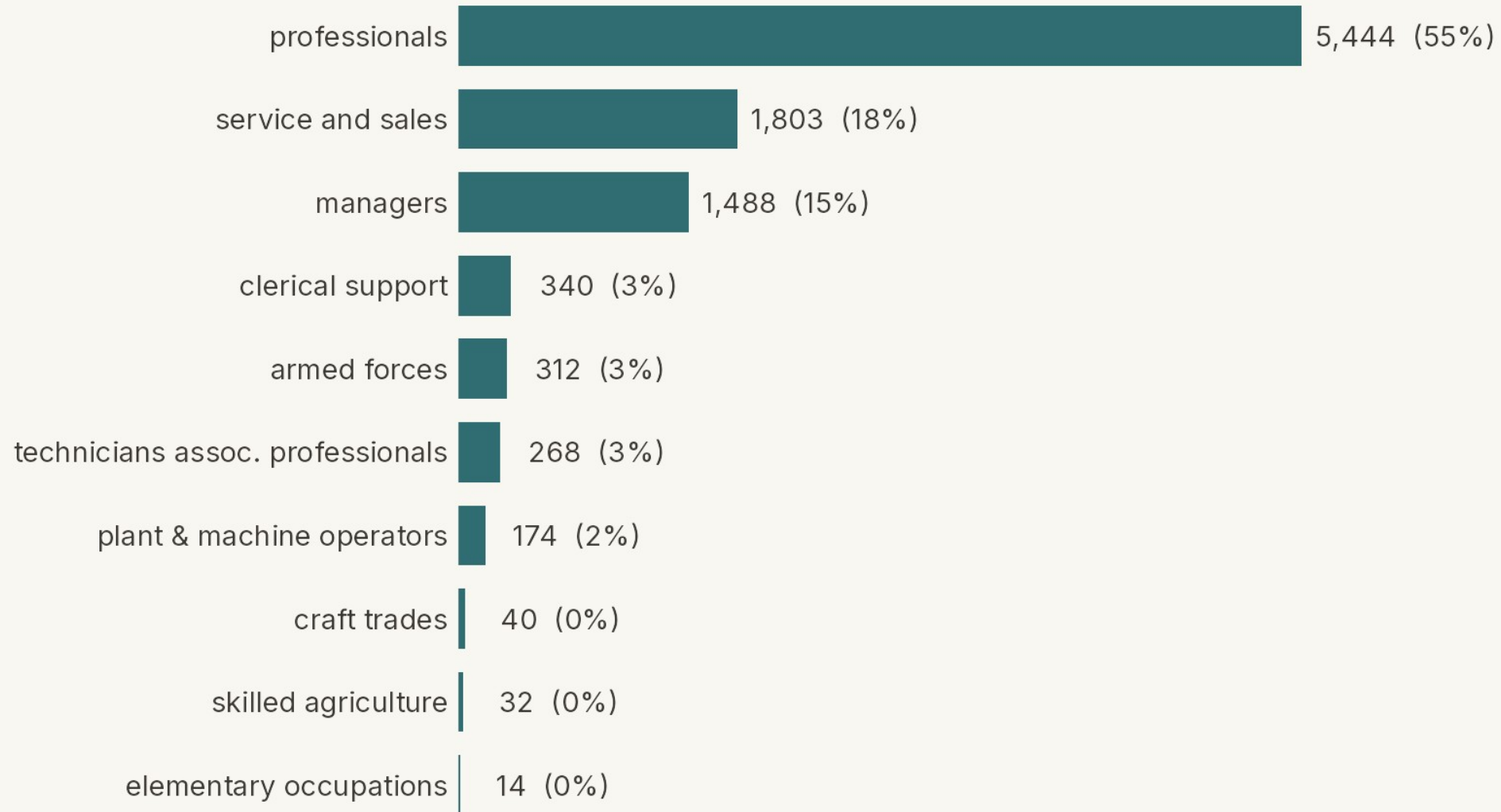
Occupation taxonomy — ISCO-08

The ILO's standard occupation taxonomy (the counterpart to ISIC) — 10 major groups, 0 (armed forces) through 9 (elementary occupations).

[Taxonomy Details Website](#)

Occupation — distribution among single-group studies

Single-group studies, N = 9,915



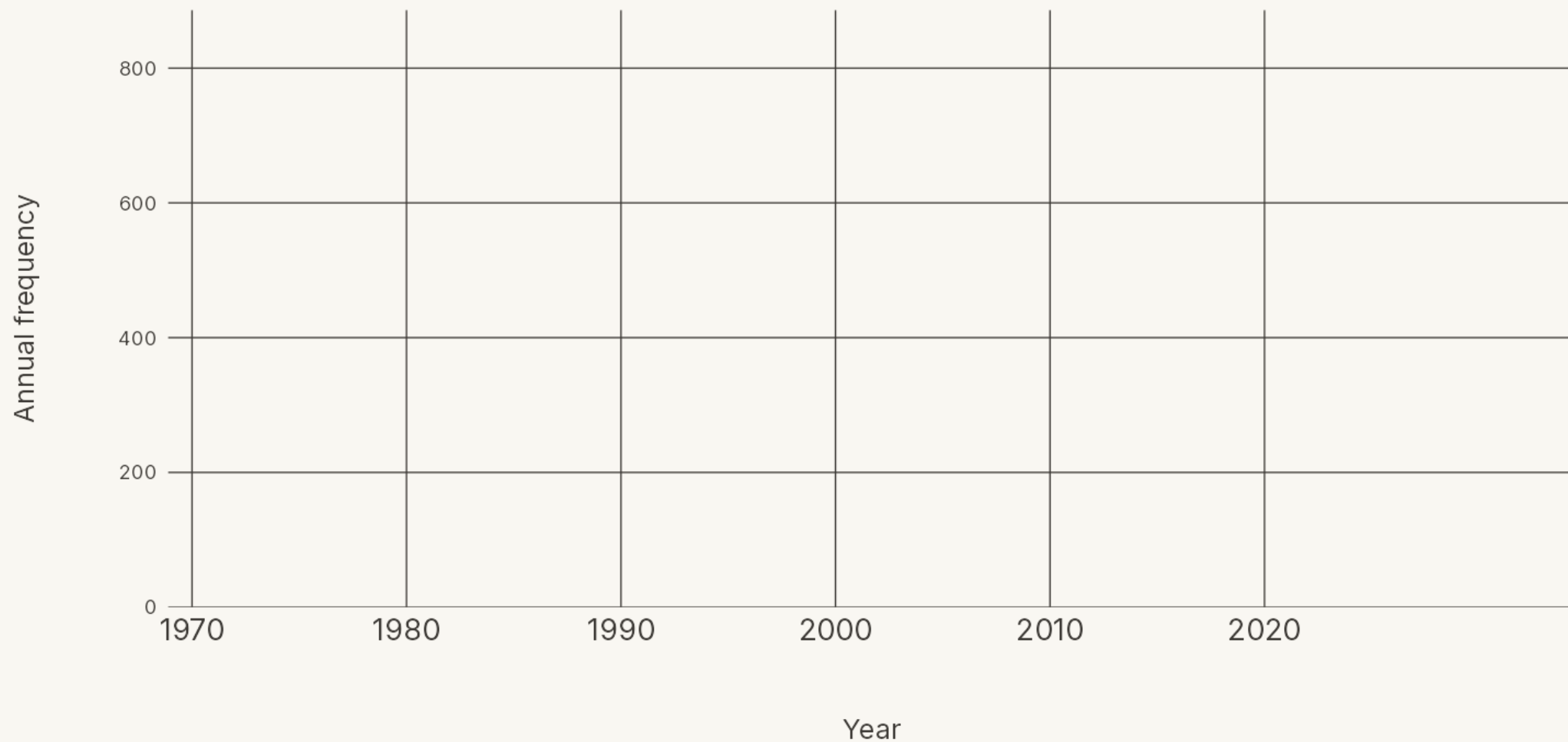
Finally, how is “organizational commitment” actually used in the literature? It plays four primary roles — as a predictor, a criterion, a correlate, and a mediator — and the balance has shifted over time.

How the four roles were assigned

We trained the AI to build a path model from each abstract's text. A variable's position in that path model determined which of the four roles it plays.

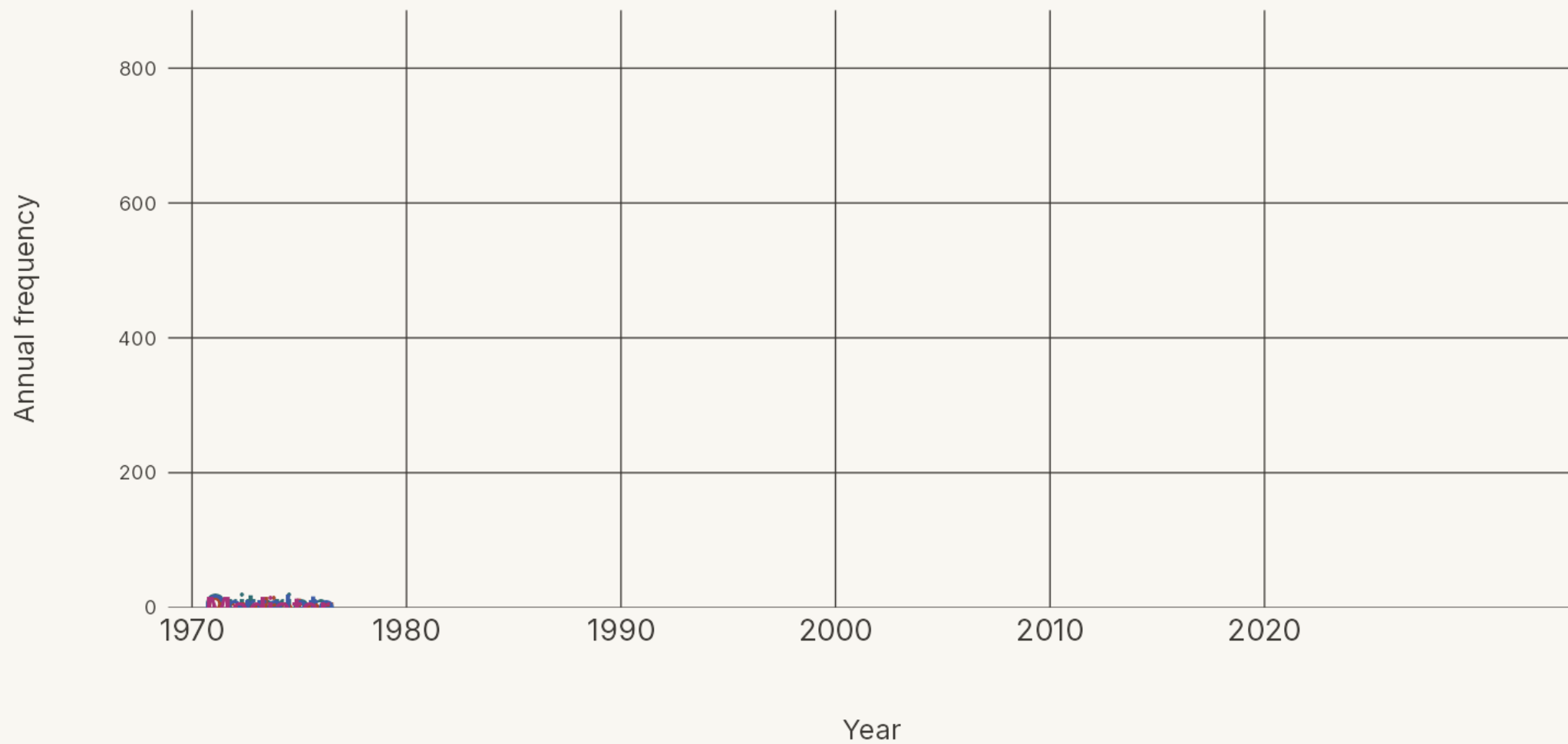
How 'organizational commitment' is used

Annual count of abstracts using commitment in each role



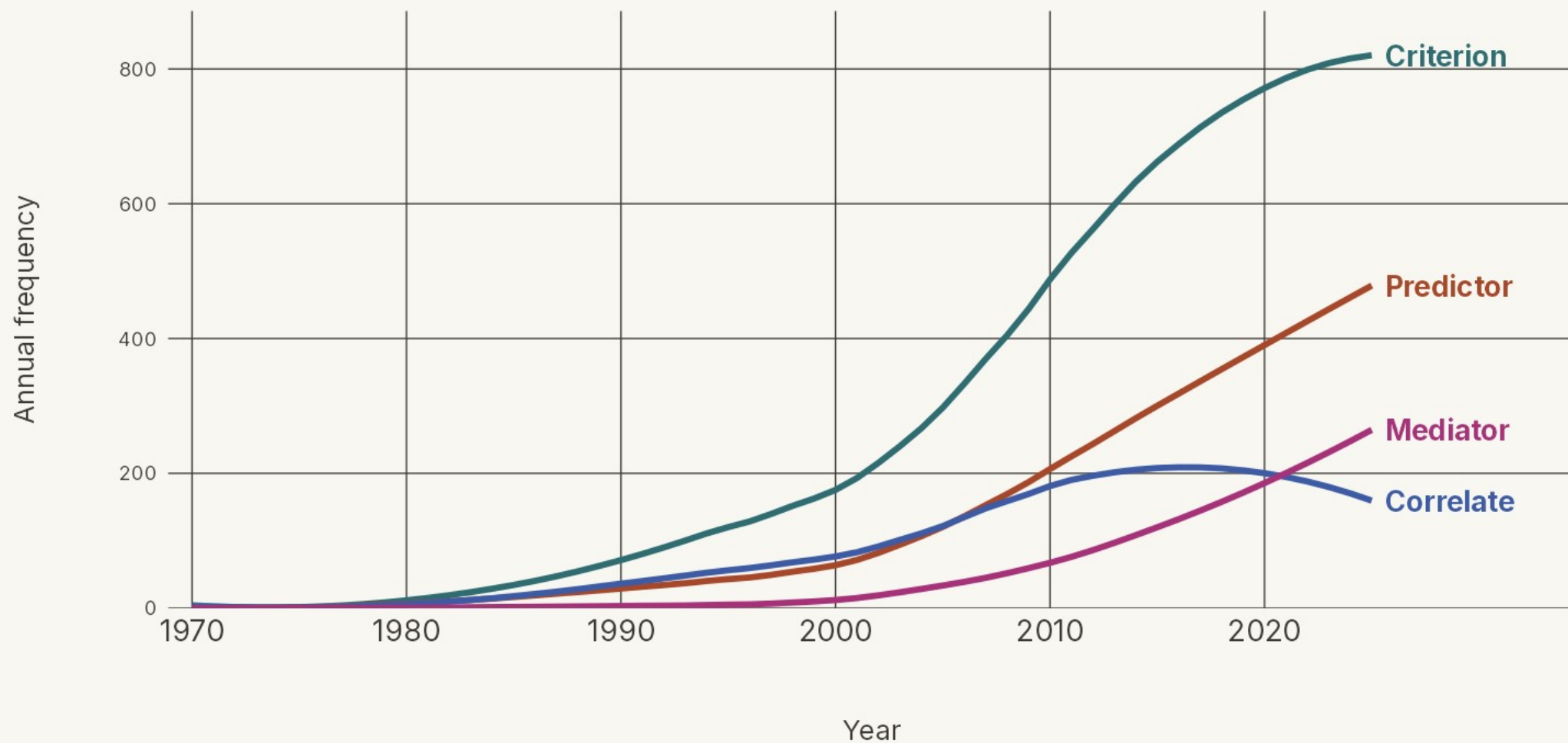
How 'organizational commitment' is used

Annual count of abstracts using commitment in each role



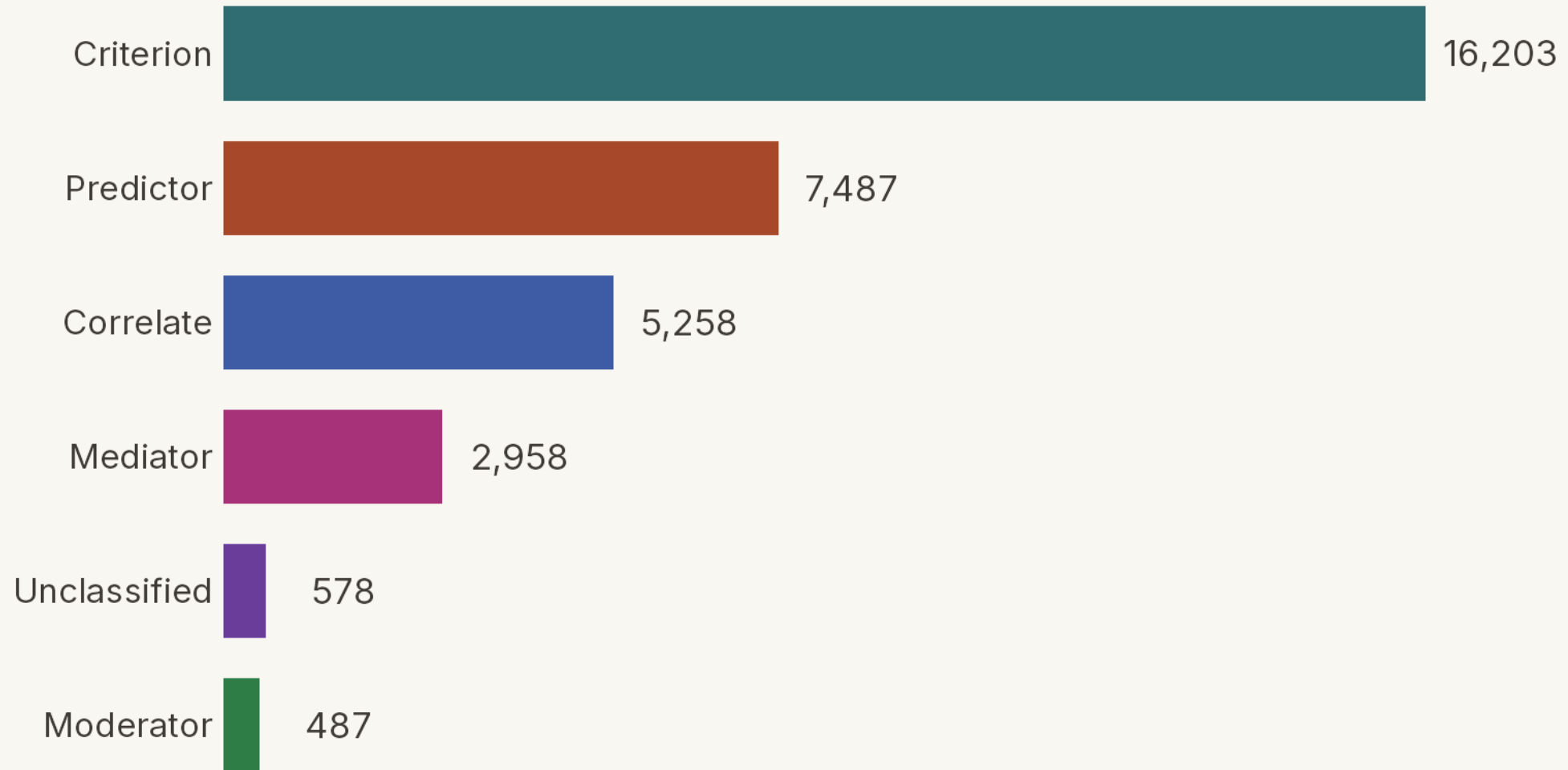
How 'organizational commitment' is used

Annual count of abstracts using commitment in each role



How 'organizational commitment' is used — all six roles

Total studies coded in each role — a study can hold several, so bars exceed the 22,484 coded



How many distinct variables did we extract?

After lightly combining spelling and plural variants — before construct grouping

Predictors of commitment

14,390

distinct variables

Outcomes of commitment

3,320

distinct variables

Light combining is cosmetic — it merges only spellings and plurals; the real reduction comes from construct grouping.

One construct, every language

For every study, the AI extracts the variables it examines — reading the abstract in its own language — and records each under one English label, so studies in any language pool into the same construct.

■ As written across languages

job satisfaction

工作满意度

satisfação no trabalho

iş tatmini

satisfacción laboral

satisfaction au travail

직무 만족

الرضا الوظيفي

English

Chinese

Portuguese

Turkish

Spanish

French

Korean

Arabic

■ The unified label

job_satisfaction

one English label · **2,085** studies pooled

The alternative — human coding — would either **miss the non-English articles** or require **hiring multiple language-proficient coders**. The AI needs neither.

How did we combine the variable labels?

Light combining — merging only plural/spelling variants, before construct grouping

BOX

1

Extract the raw labels

Direct extraction of the coded text,
“as is.”

BOX

2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Combine simple plural and spelling variants (e.g., “policies” → “policy”).

BOX

3

Group by meaning

Group labels with the same meaning into broad families (shown next).

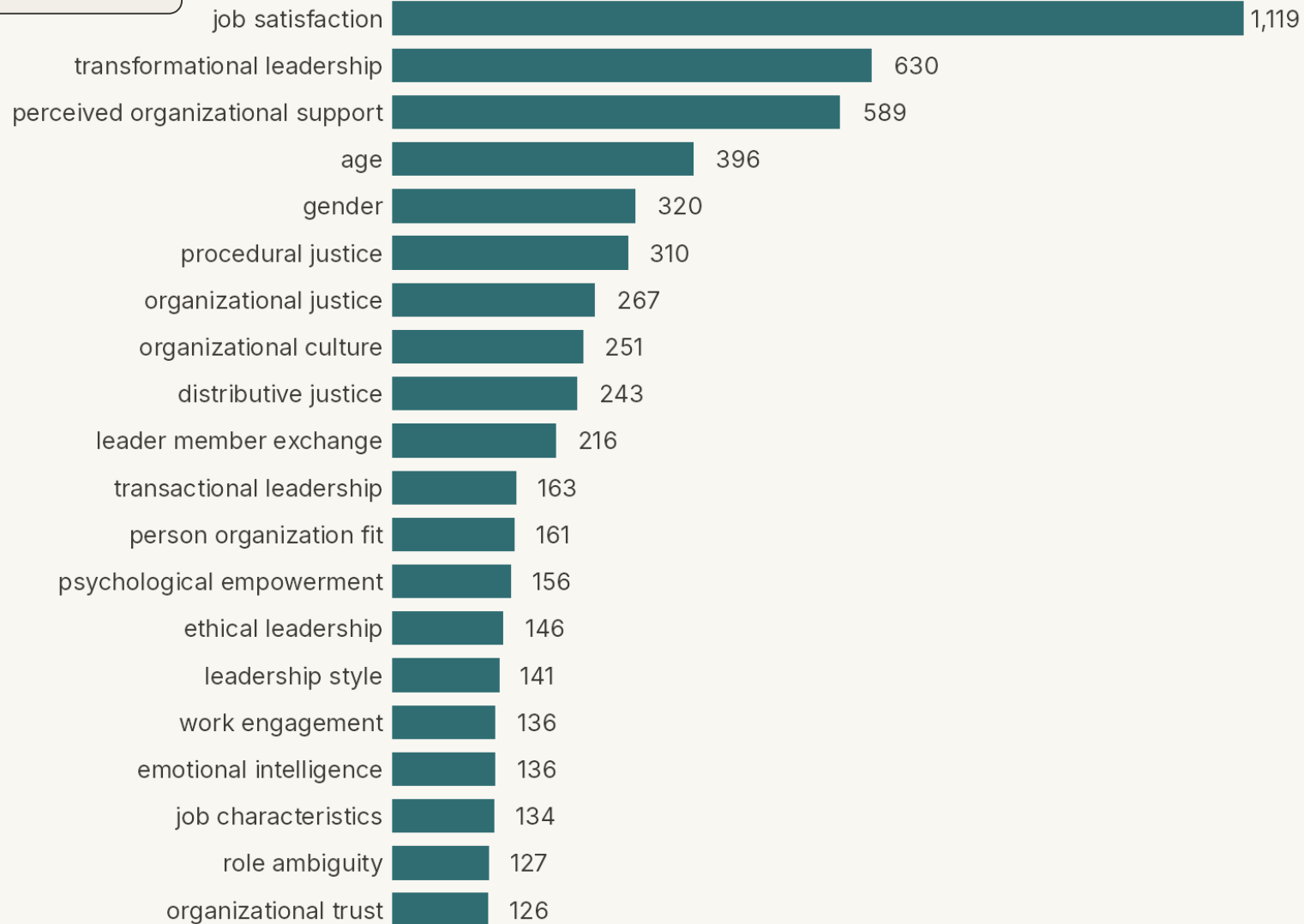
Conservative by design — spelling merges are verified against the coded labels and logged, and the meaning-based grouping (Box 3) is a first pass, still under coauthor review.

Box 2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Top 20 predictors of organizational commitment

Of 14,390 distinct predictor variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



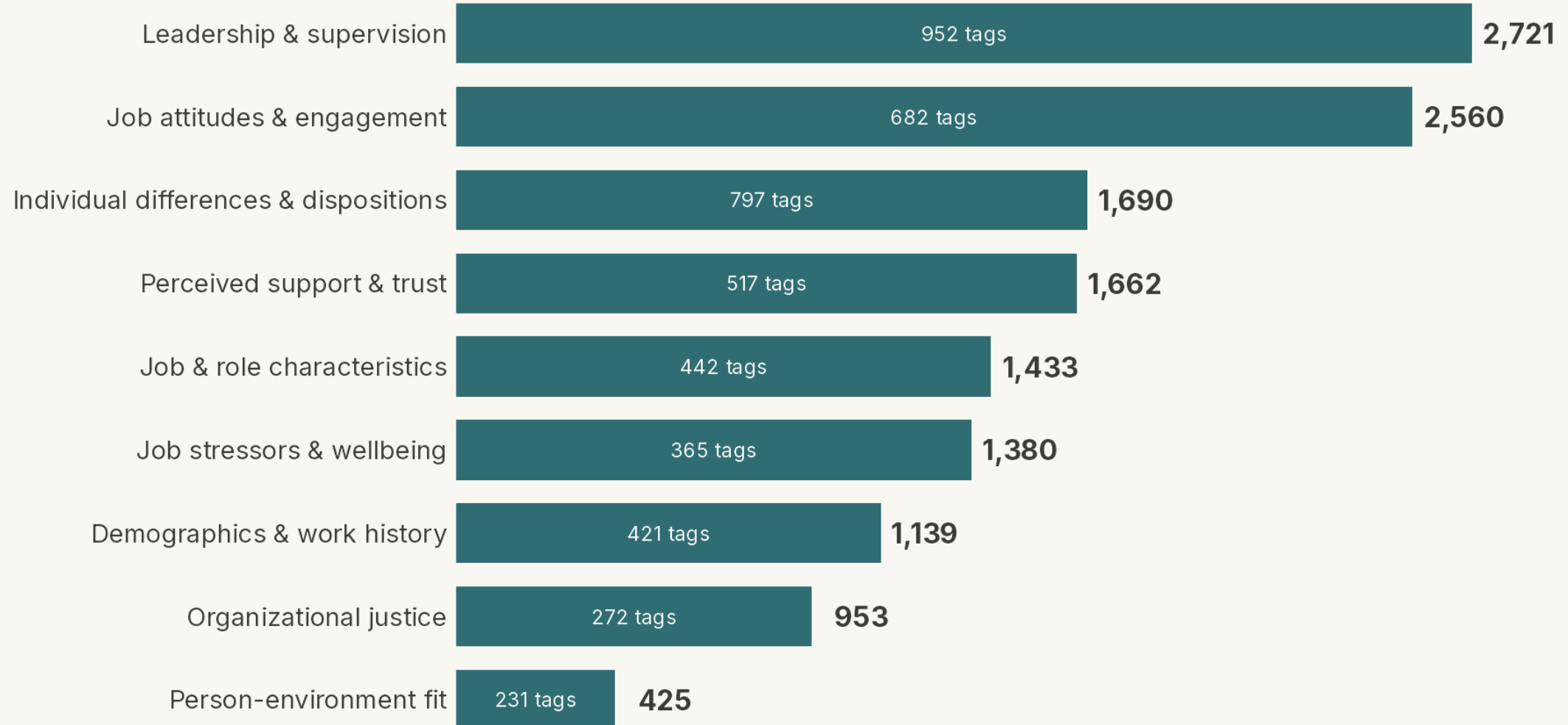
Box 3

Group by meaning

Predictors of organizational commitment, in nine categories

Bar & end label = distinct studies naming ≥ 1 predictor in the category.

Inside each bar = number of variables (tags) collapsed into it. ("Other" not shown.)

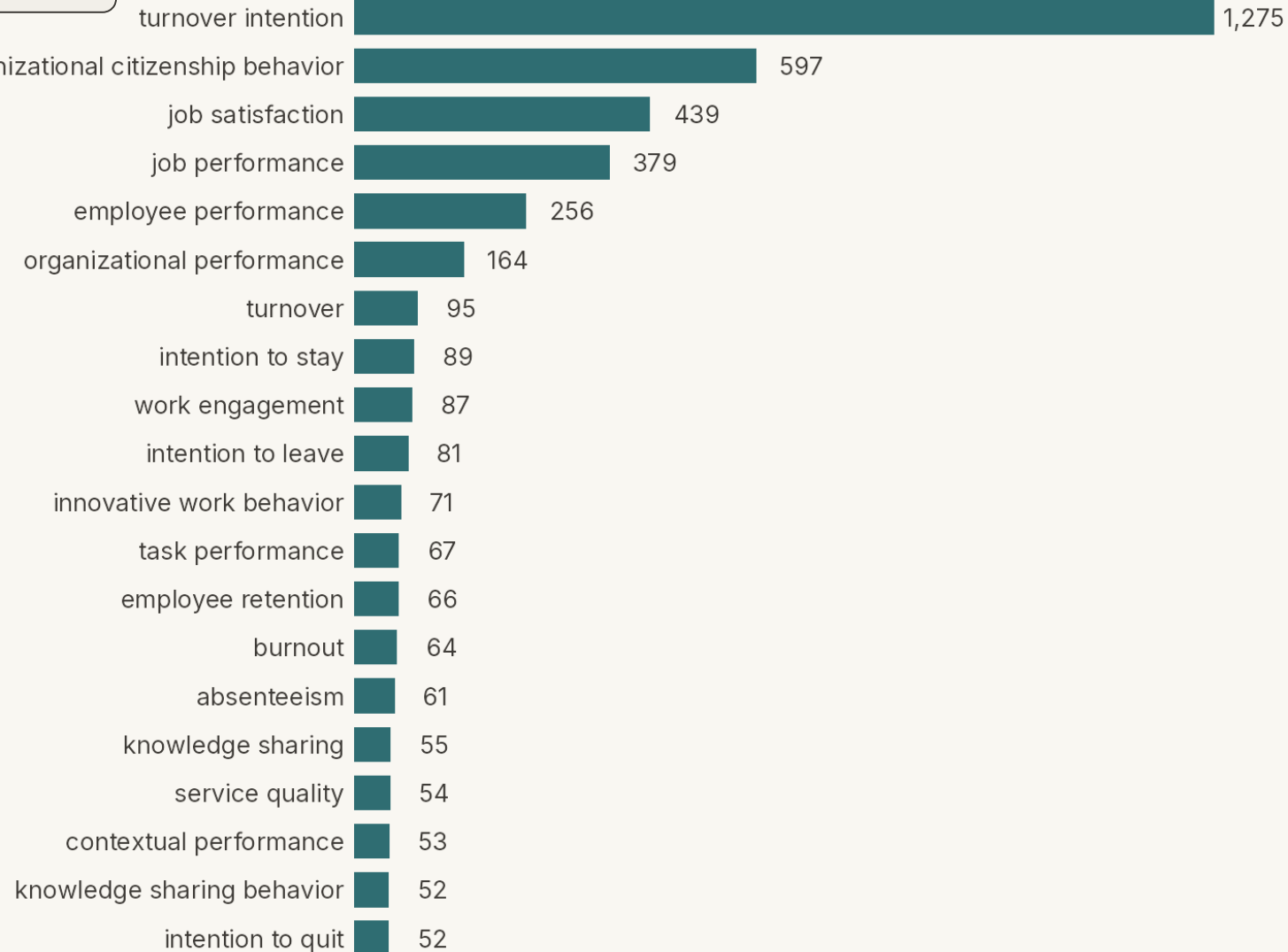


Box 2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Top 20 outcomes of organizational commitment

Of 3,320 distinct outcome variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



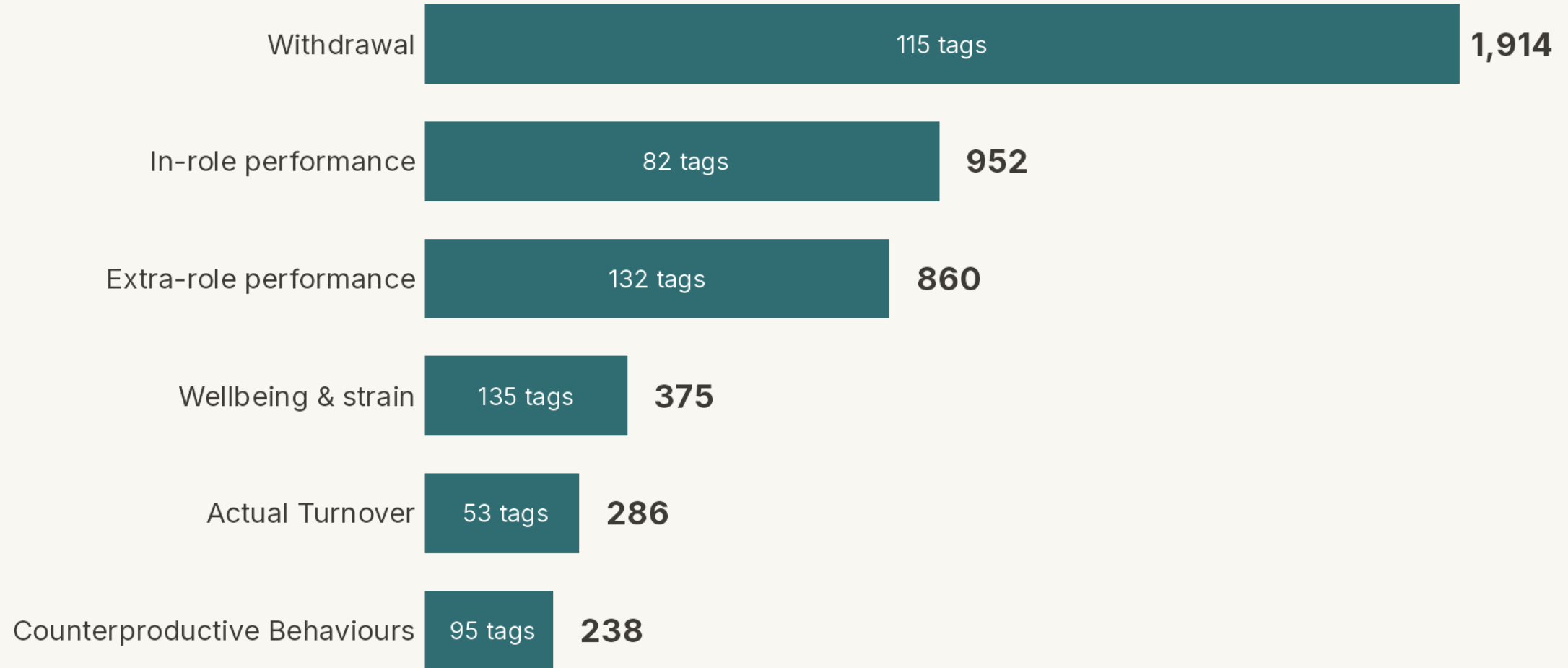
Box 3

Group by meaning

Outcomes of organizational commitment, in six categories

Bar & end label = distinct studies naming ≥ 1 outcome in the category.

Inside each bar = number of variables (tags) collapsed into it.



Top 20 correlates of organizational commitment

Of 4,030 distinct correlate variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



FROM ABSTRACTS TO ANALYSIS

Next Steps

The work ahead, in four steps.

How accurate is AI coding? — from prior research

The labour-intensive part is the coding itself — reading each study and pulling out every sample size, mean, correlation, and reliability by hand. In earlier published validation, the AI was compared against the expert human teams who did exactly that.

■ Data extraction — the coding itself

97.0%

AI accuracy — vs **92.1%** for expert human coders

4 meta-analyses · 632 studies · 20,476 data points

■ What the AI is being compared to

One of the four meta-analyses, single-coded by hand:

130 hrs → **4 hrs**
one coder ≈ 32× faster the AI

12,025 numbers from 390 studies — one coder, about 20 min a study.

[Mehr, A., Howard, J. L., Nouroozi, C., Khorramnazari, B., Banks, G. C., Tay, L., Cuijpers, P., Miguel, C., Harrer, M., Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Wang, X., Luo, G., Huo, B., Liu, J., & Rousseau, D. M. \(2026\). *Improving Evidence Synthesis with Artificial Intelligence* \[Preprint\].](#)

Next steps

From the coded abstracts to a completed meta-analysis — four steps from here.

1

Download the articles

Retrieve the full texts behind the coded abstracts.

2

Code the articles

Extract effect sizes and study details from each.

3

Formalize the variable taxonomies

Finalize the construct groupings from these results.

4

Begin analyses

Run the meta-analytic models.

VIEW & SHARE THESE SLIDES



tinyurl.com/icap2026-commitment

Toward an AI-assisted Comprehensive Meta-analysis of the Organizational Commitment Literature

meyer@uwo.ca · dstanley@uoguelph.ca · jespinoz@uwo.ca · amir@thesynthesis.company



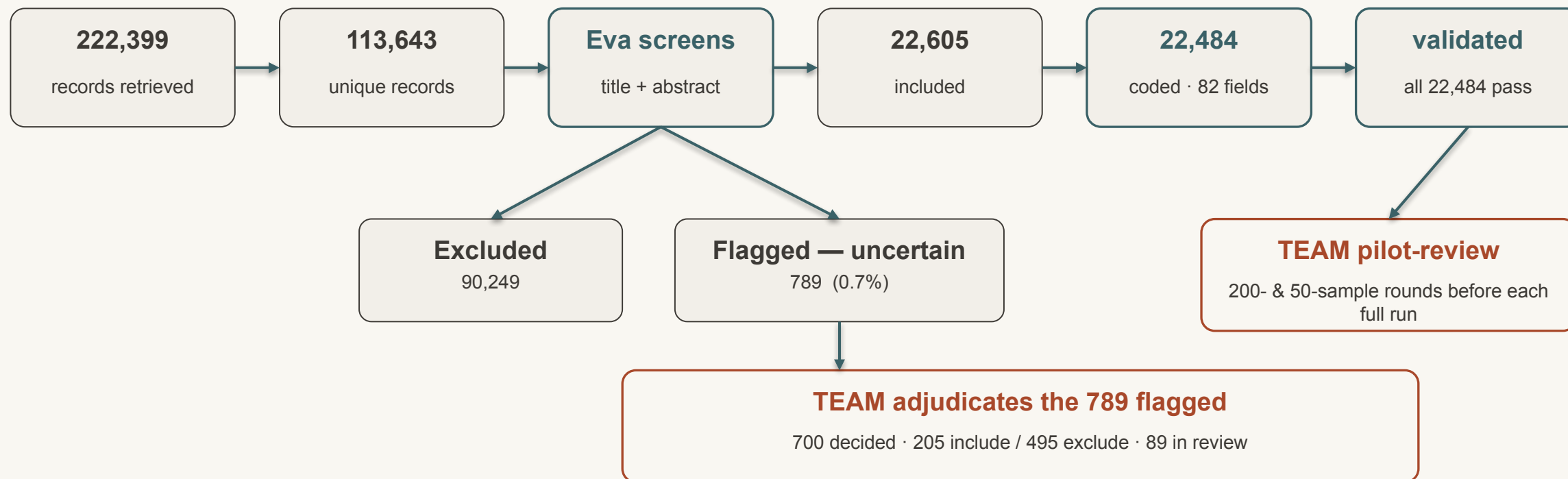
FOR READERS OF THE DOWNLOADED SLIDES

Methodological Deep Dive

The pipeline, calibration, coding scheme, and full counts — detail we skip in the talk.

The workflow, end to end

Every record's path — the fan-out at screening, and the human decisions, made explicit



☐ automated (Eva)

☐ human (team)

☐ record counts

The pipeline in full

Every record's path from retrieval to coded abstract — human steps marked in brown

1	Retrieve	222,399 records — 7 databases, keyword + cited-reference searches
2	De-duplicate	113,643 unique records after removing overlapping hits
3	Screen	Eva screens all 113,643 on title + abstract against 4 criteria (err toward inclusion): 22,605 include · 90,249 exclude · 789 flagged uncertain (0.7%)
4	Adjudicate	Team decides the 789 flagged cases — 700 resolved (205 include / 495 exclude); final 89 in review
5	Code	22,484 abstracts (121 of the 22,605 relevant records had no abstract to code) — 82 structured fields each, with a verbatim quote per field
6	Validate	All 22,484 pass automated consistency checks; team pilot-reviews before each full run

Calibration & human oversight

Humans ran a blind spot-check, then concentrated effort on the cases the AI itself flagged as uncertain

STAGE	WHEN	WHAT HAPPENED
Initial alignment	Sep 2025	40 abstracts blind-reviewed — 39/40 agreement (the one mismatch was a case Eva had flagged uncertain). Adopted the rule: when in doubt, err toward inclusion.
Uncertain-case calibration	Jan–Feb 2026	195 records from ~5,400 uncertain cases, blind-reviewed by three team members. Disagreements traced to undefined rules (missing / non-English abstracts) — the reviewers disagreed too. Rules made explicit; the whole set re-screened → uncertain cases fell from ~5,400 to 789.
Uncertainty adjudication	Feb–Mar 2026	Team hand-reviewed the 789 flagged cases: 700 decided (205 include / 495 exclude); final 89 in review.
Coding pilot	May–Jun 2026	Codebook built with the team; a 50-sample review + async re-test surfaced 5 fixes (e.g., a mandatory path-diagram step, a level-of-analysis field). Only then the full 22,484 run.

Net: roughly 1% of the 113,643 records ever needed manual screening — concentrated exactly where the abstracts were genuinely ambiguous.

What was coded

82 structured fields per abstract — each carrying a verbatim quote as its evidence

PATH-MODEL FIRST

Eva drew each study's path model, located commitment within it, and only then assigned commitment's role — predictor, outcome, mediator, or moderator.

The 82 fields capture

- Commitment role (predictor / outcome / mediator / moderator)
- Commitment type (affective / continuance / normative)
- Level of analysis (individual / unit / organization)
- Country of data collection (4-level evidence hierarchy)
- Industry — ISIC Rev. 4
- Occupation — ISCO-08
- Every predictor, outcome, mediator & moderator variable
- Variable names normalized to standard English (any source language)

Evidence, not assertion — every field carries a verbatim quote from the abstract to support it.

The numbers — and where they come from

Counts are verified from this project's database; accuracy figures belong to the validation study

THIS PROJECT — DATABASE-VERIFIED

222,399 records retrieved

113,643 unique after de-duplication

22,605 included · 90,249 excluded

789 flagged uncertain (0.7%)

700 human adjudications (205 incl / 495 excl)

~1% of records needed any manual screening

22,484 abstracts coded · 82 fields each

39/40 project blind-check agreement

FROM THE VALIDATION STUDY — MEHR ET AL.

Screening

97.2% / 91.6% vs expert human screeners

Coding

97.0% / 92.1% vs expert human coders

Tested on

5 meta-analyses · 30,150 screening documents

Sensitivity and specificity are properties of the validation study, not of this meta-analysis. This project reports only its own database-verified counts and the 39/40 blind-check.

SEED STUDIES FOR THE CITED-REFERENCE SEARCH

Foundational Works

What we mean by “foundational” — the studies whose citations we followed in the cited-reference search.

Foundational works

1 OF 2

The cited-reference search retrieved every record citing any of these 14 works

Allen, N. J., & Meyer, J. P. (1990). The measurement and antecedents of affective, continuance and normative commitment to the organization. *Journal of Occupational Psychology*, 63(1), 1–18.

Allen, N. J., & Meyer, J. P. (1996). Affective, continuance, and normative commitment to the organization: An examination of construct validity. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 49(3), 252–276.

Cook, J., & Wall, T. (1980). New work attitude measures of trust, organizational commitment and personal need non-fulfilment. *Journal of Occupational Psychology*, 53(1), 39–52.

Klein, H. J., Cooper, J. T., Molloy, J. C., & Swanson, J. A. (2014). The assessment of commitment: Advantages of a unidimensional, target-free approach. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 99(2), 222–238.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1984). Testing the “side-bet theory” of organizational commitment: Some methodological considerations. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 69(3), 372–378.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1991). A three-component conceptualization of organizational commitment. *Human Resource Management Review*, 1(1), 61–89.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1997). *Commitment in the workplace: Theory, research, and application*. Sage Publications.

Foundational works

2 OF 2

The cited-reference search retrieved every record citing any of these 14 works

Meyer, J. P., Allen, N. J., & Smith, C. A. (1993). Commitment to organizations and occupations: Extension and test of a three-component conceptualization. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 78(4), 538–551.

Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Herscovitch, L., & Topolnytsky, L. (2002). Affective, continuance, and normative commitment to the organization: A meta-analysis of antecedents, correlates, and consequences. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 61(1), 20–52.

Mowday, R. T., Porter, L. W., & Steers, R. M. (1982). *Employee–organization linkages: The psychology of commitment, absenteeism, and turnover*. Academic Press.

Mowday, R. T., Steers, R. M., & Porter, L. W. (1979). The measurement of organizational commitment. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 14(2), 224–247.

O'Reilly, C. A., III, & Chatman, J. (1986). Organizational commitment and psychological attachment: The effects of compliance, identification, and internalization on prosocial behavior. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 71(3), 492–499.

Porter, L. W., Steers, R. M., Mowday, R. T., & Boulian, P. V. (1974). Organizational commitment, job satisfaction, and turnover among psychiatric technicians. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 59(5), 603–609.

Powell, D. M., & Meyer, J. P. (2004). Side-bet theory and the three-component model of organizational commitment. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 65(1), 157–177.